

Clean and sterile

High-energy UV radiation kills germs by damaging their DNA (see page 190). In places such as hospitals, robots equipped with UV lamps are used to quickly and effectively disinfect patient rooms and hallways.



Examining rocks

Some minerals glow under UV lamps. The mineral willemite glows green, while fluorite can glow white or purple. This is caused by fluorescence—a process in which a substance absorbs UV radiation and then emits visible light.



Hygiene checks

UV lamps can be used to check how clean a surface is. The radiation causes things such as bacteria and bodily fluids, including saliva, to become visible. This UV image shows how saliva and other fluids collect on the inside of a face mask.



Real or fake

Paper currency can be checked to see if it is real by shining UV light on it and looking for fluorescing patterns, which have been added by the government. This acts as a security feature that prevents people from making counterfeit money.

Many animals,
such as **reindeer,**
bats, and **bees,**
can see UV light.